CRAFT & COLOURS

CMS content guide

How to manage products, workshops, journal posts, settings and users in WordPress.

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Before you start

You edit content at **cms.craftandcolors.africa/wp-admin**, and shoppers see it on **craftandcolors.africa** after the site rebuilds. The storefront is a separate copy of your content, so saving in WordPress does not change it instantly.

When changes go live

1. You click **Publish** or **Update**.
2. WordPress waits about 5 minutes, so several edits are grouped into one rebuild.
3. GitHub rebuilds and uploads the site, which takes a few more minutes.
4. Refresh the storefront page to see the change.

Allow 10 to 20 minutes in total. Administrators and Shop Managers can skip the 5-minute wait by clicking **Rebuild site** in the black bar at the top of WordPress.

What updates without a rebuild

Shown to shoppers	When it updates
Cart and checkout prices and stock	Immediately
Seats left on workshop pages	Immediately
Prices and stock on shop pages	After the next rebuild
Seats left on the home page	After the next rebuild
Everything else	After the next rebuild

Changes that need a manual rebuild

These do not start a rebuild on their own, so click **Rebuild site** afterwards:

- A scheduled sale starting or ending.
- A workshop's date passing. It stays listed as upcoming until the next rebuild, although RSVPs close on time.
- Editing an image's alt text in the Media Library.
- Saving variations, unless you also click **Update** on the product.

Products

Create products under **Products → Add new**, and choose **Simple product** unless shoppers need to pick an option such as colour or size. Only Administrators and Shop Managers can edit products.

Create a simple product

1. Go to **Products → Add new**.
2. Enter the product name.
3. Write the long description in the main editor. It appears under **Details** on the product page.
4. In **Product data**, leave the type as **Simple product**.
5. On the **General** tab, enter the **Regular price** in KES. Add a **Sale price** only if it is on offer.
6. On the **Inventory** tab, tick **Stock management** and enter the **Quantity**. Add an SKU if you use them.
7. Fill in **Short description**. It appears near the top of the product page.
8. Fill in **Good to know** for care, safety or usage tips. Leave it empty to use the site-wide default.
9. Choose at least one category in **Product categories**.
10. Set the **Product image**, and add other photos under **Product gallery**.
11. Click **Publish**.

Where each field appears

WordPress field	On the storefront
Product name	Product cards and page heading
Short description	Near the top of the product page and in search results
Main description	**Details** section
Good to know	**Good to know** section
Product image	Shop card and first gallery slide
First gallery image	Second slide, and the card's image on hover
Regular and sale price	Price, sale marking and the shop's sale filter

If the main description is empty, **Details** uses the short description. An empty section is hidden.

Product photos

- Use portrait 4:5 photos, about 1200 × 1500 px.
- Do not add the main image to the gallery as well.
- Drag gallery images to reorder them, then click **Update**. Gallery changes are not saved until you do.
- Write alt text in the **Alternative text** field when you choose the image. Describe the photo, for example "Set of 12 acrylic paint tubes in a box".
- The product name is used if alt text is empty.

Create a product with options

Use a **Variable product** when each option has its own price or stock. Set up the attribute first, as described under Attributes.

1. Create the product as above, then change **Product data** to **Variable product**.
2. On the **Attributes** tab, add the attribute and select its values.
3. Tick **Used for variations**, then click **Save attributes**.
4. On the **Variations** tab, click **Generate variations**.
5. Open each variation and enter its **Regular price** and stock. A variation without a price cannot be bought.
6. Click **Save changes** on the **Variations** tab.
7. Click **Publish** or **Update** on the product. This starts the rebuild.

Edit, hide or remove a product

To do this	Do this
Change price, stock or text	Open the product, edit it and click **Update**
Update several products	Tick them in **All products**, then use **Bulk actions** → **Edit**
Mark as sold out	Set the quantity to 0
Hide from the shop but keep its link	Set **Catalog visibility** to **Hidden** in the **Publish** box
Remove from the site	Click **Move to Trash**

Avoid changing the **Permalink** of a published product. Its address is `/shop/<slug>/`, so old links and search results would stop working.

Fields that have no effect yet

- **Featured** (the star) does not change anything on the storefront. The home page lists bestsellers by sales.
- The **Upsells** and **Cross-sells** fields are not shown.
- The **Fresh arrivals** shop filter currently finds nothing, because the storefront has no rule yet for what counts as new.

Categories, tags and attributes

Categories organise the shop, and attributes power product options and shop filters. Tags are not shown on the storefront, so you can skip them.

Categories

Manage categories under **Products → Categories**. The storefront depends on these seven slugs, so do not rename or delete them:

Category slug	Used for
`paint`	Shop menu, home page
`stitch-sew`	Shop menu, home page
`clay`	Shop menu
`sketch`	Shop menu
`kids`	Shop menu, home page
`diy-kits`	Shop menu, DIY kits page
`bundles`	Shop menu, home page (first 3 products)

To add a category:

1. Enter its **Name**. WordPress creates the **Slug** for you.
2. Click **Add new category**.
3. Assign at least one published product. A category appears in the shop only once it has one.

Keep categories flat by leaving **Parent category** set to **None**. Shop filters only count products placed directly in a category. New categories use a generic icon and description in the shop menu, and a developer can change them. The category **Description** and **Thumbnail** are not shown on the storefront.

Attributes

An attribute is a property shared by products, such as Finish, and its terms are the values, such as Matte and Satin. Create them centrally, because attributes added on a single product cannot be shop filters.

1. Go to **Products → Attributes**.
2. Enter a **Name**, such as Finish, and click **Add attribute**. Do not use the slugs `category`, `fresh`, `sale` or `max`, which the shop already uses.
3. Click **Configure terms** beside the attribute, and add each value.
4. Open a product, go to **Product data → Attributes**, and add the attribute with the values that apply.
5. Click **Save attributes**, then **Update**.

Shop filters

Each category chooses its own filters, so Paint can filter by Finish while Stitch & Sew filters by Fibre.

1. Go to **Products → Categories** and click **Edit** on the category.
2. Find the **Shop filters** table.

3. For each attribute, set the options below.
4. Click **Update**.

Option	What it does
Show	Turns the filter on for this category
Position	Sets the order, with lower numbers first
Label	Sets the shopper-facing name. Leave empty to use the attribute's name
Shoppers can pick	**One** option or **many**

A filter only lists values used by products in that category. If no product uses the attribute, the filter does not appear.

Workshops and meetups

The **Ticket product** field decides how a session is booked. With no ticket it is a free RSVP, and with a ticket it is paid through the cart.

	Free session	Paid session
Ticket product	None — free meetup (RSVP)	A WooCommerce product you create
Booking	Name and email form on the site	Cart and checkout
Seats left	Capacity minus RSVPs	The ticket's stock quantity
Price	Free	The ticket's price

Type only sets the label, Workshop or Meetup. It does not make a session free or paid.

Create a free session

1. Go to **Workshops → Add New**.
2. Enter the title. Check it carefully, because the page address is created from it when you first publish, and later title changes do not update the address.
3. Write the full description in the main editor.
4. Write one or two sentences in **Excerpt** for workshop cards. If you leave it empty, WordPress shortens the description.
5. Fill in **Session details** using the table below.
6. Set the **Featured image**, ideally a landscape 16:10 photo at least 1200 px wide. Add alt text when you choose it.
7. Click **Publish**.

Session detail	What to enter
Starts	Date and start time, in Nairobi time. **Required:** a session without it does not appear on the site
Ends (time)	End time on the same day. The site works out the duration from it
Type	Workshop or Meetup
Skill level	For example, "Zero experience needed"
Location	Defaults to Village Market, Nairobi
Capacity	Number of seats. **A free session left at 0 shows as fully booked**
Ticket product	Leave as **None** for a free session

Create a paid session

Create the ticket first, then link it to the session.

1. Go to **Products → Add new** and name the ticket after the session.
2. Tick **Virtual** in **Product data**. Only virtual products appear in the ticket list.
3. Enter the **Regular price**.
4. On the **Inventory** tab, tick **Stock management** and set **Quantity** to the number of seats.

5. In the **Publish** box, set **Catalog visibility** to **Hidden**, so the ticket stays out of the shop.
6. Publish the ticket.
7. Create the session as above, and select the ticket under **Ticket product**.
8. Set **Capacity** to the same number as the ticket's quantity.
9. Click **Publish**.

Edit a session

Open it under **Workshops → All workshops**, change it and click **Update**. That list also shows each session's start time and seats left.

- **Add seats to a free session:** raise **Capacity**.
- **Add seats to a paid session:** raise the ticket's stock **Quantity**, and update **Capacity** to match.
- **Change a paid session's price:** edit the ticket's price, not the workshop.
- **Cancel a session:** set it back to **Draft** or move it to the Trash, then contact anyone already booked.

Past sessions move to the past section of the Workshops page after a rebuild. Leave them published if you want them to stay there.

See who has booked

- **Free sessions:** open the session and look at the **RSVPs** box on the right. Click **Download CSV** for a spreadsheet.
- **Paid sessions:** go to **WooCommerce → Orders** and look for orders containing the ticket.

The storefront ignores repeat RSVPs from the same email address. WordPress has no button for removing an RSVP, so ask your developer if you need one deleted.

Journal posts

Journal posts are normal WordPress posts under **Posts**. The **Journal** page shows the newest 24, and the home page shows the newest 3.

Create a post

1. Go to **Posts → Add New Post**.
2. Enter the title. It becomes the large heading on the page.
3. Write the article in the main area. Start your headings at **Heading 2**, because the title is already the top-level heading.
4. Open the **Post** tab in the right sidebar.
5. Choose or create a **Category**. Avoid leaving it as **Uncategorized**, because the category name is shown above the title.
6. Set the **Featured image**, ideally a landscape 3:2 photo at least 1600 px wide, and add alt text.
7. Write the **Excerpt**, one or two sentences.
8. Check the **Slug** under **URL**. Keep it short, and do not change it after publishing.
9. Click **Publish**.

To publish later, change **Publish: Immediately** to a future date before clicking **Schedule**. The site rebuilds when the post goes out.

Where each field appears

WordPress field	On the storefront
Title	Page heading, journal cards and search results
Excerpt	Introduction under the title, and the description in search results
Content	The body of the article
Featured image	Large image on the page, journal cards and the preview when the link is shared
Category	Small label above the title
Publish date	Shown beside the category, and sets the order of posts

Excerpt or content: the excerpt is a short summary that sits above the article, while the content is the article itself. Do not paste the same opening paragraph into both, or it will appear twice in a row.

Comments, tags and the author's name are not shown on the storefront.

Edit or remove a post

Open it under **Posts → All Posts**, change it and click **Save** or **Update**. To take it down, switch it to **Draft** or click **Move to Trash**. Its page disappears after the rebuild, so any links to it stop working.

About page, Contact page and maker posts

These smaller content types are also managed in WordPress.

Content	Where	How it works
About page	**Pages**, slug `about`	Title is the page heading, and content is the main text
Contact page	**Pages**, slug `contact`	Title is the page heading, and content appears above the form
"Made by you" home wall	**Maker posts**	Title is the Instagram handle, Excerpt is the caption, and Featured image is the photo. Lower **Order** numbers come first. A post without an image is not shown

Other pages created under **Pages** do not appear on the storefront. The policies page and the home page's text are part of the site's code, so ask your developer to change them.

Settings

Most day-to-day settings are under **Craft & Colours → Settings**. Administrators and Shop Managers can open it.

Craft & Colours menu

Setting	What it does
Announcement ticker	Scrolling text at the top of every page. Enter one announcement per line, or leave empty to hide it
Gift product	Product added free once the cart reaches KES 5,000. It must be a simple product priced at 0, set to **Hidden**, with stock managed
Default "Good to know"	Used on any product whose own **Good to know** box is empty
Storefront rebuild	Shows the last and next rebuild requests, with a **Rebuild now** button
Subscribers	Newsletter sign-ups, with **Download CSV**

WooCommerce settings

Go to **WooCommerce → Settings**. Change these only when the shop's policy changes.

Tab	What it controls	Expected setup
General	Store address, selling countries, currency	Village Market, Nairobi. Kenyan shilling (KES)
Products → Inventory	Stock management and low-stock level	Stock management on, low stock at 2, as shown in the **Low stock** dashboard box
Shipping	Delivery zones, prices and free delivery	See the table below
Payments	How customers pay	**Order now, pay on confirmation** is the only method. Keep it on, or checkout will not work
Emails	Order email wording and sender details	Sent using WP Mail SMTP
Site visibility	Whether the WooCommerce store is live	Should be **Live**. A "Coming soon" badge at the top of WordPress means it is not

Delivery zone (order matters)	Regions	Methods
Nairobi	Nairobi County	Flat rate KES 300. Free shipping on orders of KES 4,500 or more
Rest of Kenya	Kenya	Flat rate KES 0, titled "Courier — cost confirmed on WhatsApp"
Uganda & Tanzania	Uganda, Tanzania	Flat rate KES 0, titled "Courier — cost confirmed on WhatsApp"

WooCommerce uses the first zone that matches, so keep Nairobi at the top. If an address matches no zone, the customer sees "No delivery options are available".

WordPress settings to leave alone

Only Administrators can open **Settings**. These values are needed for the storefront to work:

Setting	Keep it as	If it changes
General → Timezone	Nairobi	Workshop times shift
Permalinks	Post name	The site cannot read content, and rebuilds fail
General → WordPress and Site Address	`https://cms.craftandcolors.africa`	Login and the storefront's connection can break

Also leave the **Plugins → Must-Use** entry named Craft & Colours in place, and keep WP Mail SMTP active. Contact messages, RSVP confirmations and order emails depend on email working.

Settings that need a developer

These are not in WordPress menus:

- The free-gift threshold of KES 5,000.
- The storefront's WhatsApp number, contact email and social links.
- The 5-minute delay before a rebuild.

Users

Give each person their own login, with the lowest role that covers their work. Only Administrators can add staff accounts.

Roles

Role	Can do	Best for
Administrator	Everything, including plugins, users and WordPress settings	The owner or developer. Keep to 1 or 2
Shop Manager	Products, orders, customers, WooCommerce settings, Craft & Colours, posts and pages	Someone running the shop every day
Editor	Posts, pages, workshops, maker posts and media. **No** products, orders or rebuild button	Someone writing content only
Author	Their own posts and workshops, and uploading images	An occasional writer
Customer	No admin work. WooCommerce uses this role for shoppers with accounts	Do not use for staff

A Shop Manager also sees orders and customer details, so choose this role only for someone who should see them.

Add a user

1. Go to **Users → Add New User**.
2. Enter a **Username**. It cannot be changed later.
3. Enter the person's own **Email**.
4. Add their first and last name.
5. Keep the generated **Password**, and leave **Send User Notification** ticked. They receive an email to set up their login.
6. Choose the **Role**.
7. Click **Add New User**.

Change or remove a user

To do this	Do this
Change a role or email	**Users → All Users**, click **Edit**, change it and click **Update User**
Reset a forgotten password	Hover over the user and click **Send password reset**, or use **Lost your password?** on the login page
Remove someone who has left	Hover over the user and click **Delete**. Choose **Attribute all content to** another user, then confirm

Choose **Attribute all content to** when deleting. The other option deletes everything that person wrote.

Never share a login or send a password by chat or email. Remove accounts on the day someone leaves.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
My change is not on the site	Wait 20 minutes and refresh the page. Then open **Craft & Colours** → **Settings** and look at **Storefront rebuild**. Click **Rebuild now** if nothing is pending
Rebuild shows "failed"	Note the HTTP number and send it to your developer. The GitHub access token may have expired or be incorrect
"Next scheduled" stays in the past	The scheduled task on the server has stopped. Click **Rebuild now**, then tell your developer
A rebuild ran but the site did not change	The build may have failed, and the live site keeps its last good version. Ask your developer to check GitHub Actions
A product is missing from the shop	Check that it is published, its **Catalog visibility** is not **Hidden**, and it has a category
A product cannot be added to the cart	Check that it has a price and is in stock. For a variable product, check that each variation has a price
A shop filter is missing	Check that **Show** is ticked on that category, the attribute is global, and a product directly in the category uses it
A workshop is missing	Check that it is published and has a **Starts** date
A free workshop shows as fully booked	Check that **Capacity** is above 0 and above the number of RSVPs
A ticket is missing from the **Ticket product** list	Check that the ticket is ticked **Virtual** and is published
Customers see "No delivery options are available"	Check that a shipping zone under **WooCommerce** → **Settings** → **Shipping** covers their address
Emails are not arriving	Send a test from **WP Mail SMTP** → **Tools** → **Email Test**, and check the spam folder
A shared link shows an old image	Social apps store previews for a while. Facebook's Sharing Debugger can refresh it, and WhatsApp may take longer